

File Backup

Here, you are simply copying a file to another location to keep as a backup. Earlier, you had to do this manually but now we have software that automate this process.

Synchronization

File Synchronisation may sound like File Backup at first but there are differences. In synchronisation, you have a mirror copy of the files selected by you at another location. Now what makes this different is that the mirrored copy is also a working copy and any changes made to it will reflect in the original file. Essentially, in synchronisation you have two 'sources' of files, unlike File Backup which has a 'Source' and a 'Destination'.

File Backup Terminology

Let us take a look at some backup-related jargon and see what they mean as a lot of backup software use these terms.

Full Backup

It means exactly what it says. It is a complete backup of the data selected by the user for backup. The files may be put in a single archive with compression and encryption, depending on the options selected by the user.

Differential Backup

In this method, only files that have changed since a last Full Backup are backed up in an archive alongside the Full Backup. Every subsequent differential backup copies the files that are different from the Full Backup even if they have been backed up in the previous differential backup.

Incremental Backup

Incremental backups only copy files that have been created or modified since the last full backup or incremental backup. While data redundancy is not as high as differential backups, it is still there as successive incremental backups will still contain files that have been backed up in the previous incremental backup but have been modified in some way. This system is faster than differential backup and even smaller in size.

Inbuilt Operating System backup tools

Windows XP

Not many will know this but Windows XP came with an inbuilt backup